

MENGLIN LIU

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen

Shenzhen, China

Assistant Professor, Computational Social Science

Aug. 2025 – Present

School of Artificial Intelligence, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen

Shenzhen, China

Assistant Professor of Artificial Intelligence (by courtesy)

Feb. 2026 – Present

RESEARCH LEADERSHIP

Reinforcement Learning & Responsible AI Group, School of Artificial Intelligence Shenzhen, China

Group Coordinator / Faculty Advisor

2026 – Present

ADVISORY ROLES

United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF), China Country Office

National AI Expert

2026 – Present

- Lead AI methodologist for UNICEF China's Evidence and Gap Map on child education and health policies, designing a responsible AI-assisted evidence synthesis pipeline to support national policy evaluation across multilingual sources.
- Develop and deploy a suite of AI agent systems — including a Deep Research Agent, a Document Coding Agent, and a Data Agent — to automate large-scale evidence retrieval, classification, and policy gap analysis for child welfare programs in China.
- Ensure all AI tools comply with United Nations ethical guidelines for AI in evaluations, embedding human-in-the-loop validation, audit logging, and bias monitoring as foundational design principles.

Shenzhen AI Industry Association (SAIIA)

Shenzhen, China

Lead Scientist, AI Safety Standards

2026

- Lead drafter of the *Specification for Security Evaluation of AI Agents* (T/AIIA), an industry standard defining safety evaluation frameworks across five dimensions: input security, behavioral safety, tool invocation control, output compliance, and data privacy protection.
- Design evaluation methodologies, risk grading systems, and adversarial testing protocols for responsible deployment of AI agent systems.
- Lead drafter of the *AI Social Organization Member Service Standard*.

EDUCATION

University of California, Davis

Davis, CA

Ph.D., Political Science

Sept. 2019 – June 2025

University of California, Davis

Davis, CA

Exchange Student, Political Science

Sept. 2017 – June 2018

Beijing Foreign Studies University

Beijing, China

B.A., English Literature

Sept. 2015 – June 2019

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Computational Social Science
- Reinforcement Learning and Agentic AI Systems
- Large Language Models and Multimodal AI for Social Science
- Text Analysis, Ideological Scaling, and Survey Measurement
- Political Behavior, Housing Politics, and Public Policy

RESEARCH

Book Chapters

- **Menglin Liu** and Xu Shan. 2021. “China: Diversion, Ingratiation, and Victimization.” In *Political Communication and COVID-19: Governance and Rhetoric in Times of Crisis*. Routledge.
- **Menglin Liu** and Xu Shan. Forthcoming. “Unraveling Crisis Communication: Assessing Strategies in China’s COVID-19 Pandemic.” In *Risk Communication and COVID-19 Governmental Communication and Management of the Pandemic*. Routledge.

Peer-Reviewed Articles

- **Menglin Liu**. 2025. “The Varied Impact of Direct Democracy on Local Housing Policies: Unraveling the Role of Socioeconomic Context.” *Local Government Studies*. Article Link.
- **Menglin Liu** and Ang Liu. 2026. “Homeownership and Preferences for Government Redistribution in China: Mediating Roles of Employment Sector and Socioeconomic Perceptions.” *Cities*. Article link.
- Joshua Clinton and **Menglin Liu**. “An Open-Ended Pandemic? Political and Behavioral Divisions During the Pandemic.” *Under Review at International Journal of Public Opinion*.
- **Menglin Liu** and Ang Liu. “Does Homeownership Influence Political Participation? Evidence from Survey Data in Contemporary China.” *Under Review at Urban Affairs Review*.
- **Menglin Liu** and Ge Shi. “PoliPrompt: A High-Performance Cost-Effective LLM-Based Text Classification Framework for Political Science.” *Under Review at Journal of Computational Social Science*.
- Ge Shi, Jun Yin, Donglin Xie, Fangyi Liu, Yucan Li and **Menglin Liu**. “JailbreakOPT: Tool-Assisted Iterative Jailbreak Prompt Optimization.” arXiv 2026.
- **Menglin Liu** and Ge Shi. “Where Prompting Hits the Wall: Diagnosing Category Boundary Complexity in LLM-Based Classification.” *Under Review at EMNLP 2026*.

Working Papers and Manuscripts in Progress

- **Menglin Liu** and Jinghong Wang. “Understanding Local Housing Debates through Automated Audio Analysis Using Diarization, Transcription, and Large Language Models.”
- **Menglin Liu** and Ge Shi. “Visual Language Models for Document Question Answering in Political Science.”

SOFTWARE AND RESEARCH TOOLS

- **PoliPrompt 2.0** (PyPI — GitHub)
- Python package for reliable and cost-effective LLM-based text classification, featuring automatic prompt optimization, dynamic exemplar selection, uncertainty-aware annotation, and human-in-the-loop review.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Teaching

- **Instructor**, Advanced Statistical Modeling in Social Science, Computational Social Science Program, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen
 - Graduate-level course on statistical modeling and machine learning for social science
 - Topics include regression models, causal inference, text analysis, large language models, and computational methods
- **Instructor**, Introduction to American Local Politics and Public Policy, Renmin University of China
 - Summer Session on Nation Governance and Public Policy, 2021

Undergraduate Teaching

- **Instructor**, AIE1901 / AIE1902: AI Explorations, School of Artificial Intelligence, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen
 - Interdisciplinary introduction to artificial intelligence applications
 - Topics include natural language processing, image analysis, multimodal models, and AI applications in social science
- **Instructor**, Scientific Study of Politics, University of California, Davis
 - 2024 Summer Session I

- 2022 Spring
- 2021 Summer Session I
- 2021 Spring
- **Instructor**, Introduction to American Politics, University of California, Davis
 - 2023 Winter
 - 2023 Summer Session I
 - 2022 Summer Session I
- **Instructor**, Group Politics, University of California, Davis
 - 2024 Spring

INVITED TALKS

- Duke Kunshan University, Computational Social Science

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Chinese Community of Political Science and International Studies, July 2020
- Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting, April 2021
- THU-PKU-RUC Political Science Research Workshop, December 2021
- American Causal Inference Conference, June 2022
- American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, September 2022
- American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, September 2023
- Annual Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology, July 2024
- American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, September 2024
- Annual Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology Asia, January 2025
- Southern Political Science Association Conference (CWC: Generative Language Models in Political Science Research), January 2025
- Yale FDS Workshop: AI for Social Science Research Methods, May 2026
- Visions in Methodology, Germany, May 2026
- Annual Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology, July 2026

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

- Provost's Fellowship in the Arts, Humanities and Social Sciences, 2019–2020 (\$58,302)
- Living Expense Fellowship, Summer 2024 (\$5,000)
- CUHK Research Grant, Data Agent, Mar. 2026 – Sept. 2026 (\$10,000)
- ByteDance Research Grant, Improving Context Memory of LLMs (\$4,000)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Committee of 100, Data & Policy Analyst, June 2023 – September 2023

REVIEWER SERVICE

- *Social Science Quarterly*
- *Communication Methods and Measures*
- *American Journal of Computer Science and Technology*
- *International Communication Association*
- *Local Government Studies*
- *Chinese Journal of Sociology*

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- American Political Science Association
- Midwest Political Science Association
- Western Political Science Association
- Southern Political Science Association
- Society for Political Methodology
- International Communication Association

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming:** Python, R, Stata
- **Machine Learning / NLP:** scikit-learn, PyTorch, TensorFlow, OpenAI API, Hugging Face
- **Data Analysis / Visualization:** pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, ggplot2, Tableau
- **Languages:** Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent), German (intermediate)

REFERENCES

- Scott MacKenzie, Professor, University of California, Davis, samackenzie@ucdavis.edu
- Lauren Peritz, Associate Professor, University of California, Davis, lperitz@ucdavis.edu
- Christopher Hare, Associate Professor, University of California, Davis, cdhare@ucdavis.edu